

Whether forums build better people is something that is beyond the scope of this book, and perhaps a conclusion best left to psychiatrists and forum members to thrash about. However, there's no denying that the right forum can help you develop your skill sets.

6.2 Forum Activity

Forums are not just places where people who love to argue get together and play one-upmanship games. Yes, this does happen often, and quite a few members on each forum are there specifically to build their egos by winning arguments, or showing off their superior knowledge, but they still aren't the majority.

Again, taking the example of the *Digit* forum, members here can be broadly classified into the following groups:

1. One-time Visitors
2. Occasional Browsers
3. Regular Contributors
4. Forum Addicts
5. Troublemakers
6. Moderators/Administrators

Read on to find out which group you probably belong to, and which you 'should' belong to.

One-time Visitors

This group is simple to comprehend: they find your site via Google or from a friend. They decide to pay it a visit when they're bored, or when they need quick answers, visit the forum a couple of times, and then forget all about its existence.

On the *Digit* forum, these members comprise about 15 per cent of the registered members. They register only because they stumbled across the site and it sparked interest, but that spark was fleeting. Other users who make up this group are those with PC or